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TUESDAY, NOVEMBER 11, 2025

Conman swiped \$1.1m from state, officials say

The suspect's target: unclaimed property fund

By Sean Cotter
GLOBE STAFF

As the advertisements all over Massachusetts say, the state's sitting on billions of dollars in unclaimed property. And \$615,000 of it belonged to Diane Rothschild.

But she died a decade ago, so her cash sat untouched with the treasurer's office until September 2023, when someone allegedly claimed it: Renaud Dutail, who provided a driver's license and legal documentation connecting him to Rothschild. Within a few months, a check for the whole amount arrived for him in Atlanta, and it was cashed.

A few months later, Rothschild's two sons reached out to the unclaimed property division: After some delays, they were now ready to receive their inheritance — could the government send them the money?

"They told us, basically, 'We already sent it out, was that not correct?'" one of her sons said when reached by phone.

FRAUD, Page A7

N.H. residents scramble as wells run dry

Persistent drought leaves households without water

By Amanda Gokee
GLOBE STAFF

CONCORD, N.H. — Kathie Lamontagne's water problems started in August, when the pressure in her home all but disappeared.

"You're just about out of water," she remembers her friend, a plumber, declaring after inspecting her well in Columbia, N.H.

For 30 years, Lamontagne has used the dug well on her property, which is relatively shallow and draws from groundwater. She's never had an issue until this year, she said, as drought conditions have engulfed the state, drying out hundreds of private wells and leaving residents without their normal supply of water.

"This is the worst year ever," said Lamontagne, a 71-year-old retiree. Nearly half of the state's residents get their water from a private well, according to the New Hampshire Department of Environmental Services.

WATER, Page A7

As pain increased, deal was forged

N.E. senators played key role, face wrath of Democratic colleagues

By Jim Puzzanghera
GLOBE STAFF

WASHINGTON — Before they became senators, Angus King, Jeanne Shaheen, and Maggie Hassan all were New England governors used to the art of compromise and deal-making.

They put that experience to the test in recent days, helping

negotiate a controversial deal to end the record-long federal government shutdown. The three, along with five other Senate Democrats, struck an agreement with Senate majority leader John Thune and then provided the pivotal votes needed to advance legislation to reopen the government. The Senate voted 60-40 to

► Governor Maura Healey urged SNAP recipients to use funds freed for them. B1.

approve the bill Monday night. The legislation now must be passed by the House and signed by President Trump, which is expected to happen in the next couple of days.

The eight senators broke ranks with most of their party colleagues in accepting the deal, which falls short of Democratic demands to extend Af-

fordable Care Act health insurance premium subsidies that expire at the end of the year. Thune, a South Dakota Republican, only promised to allow a vote next month on a still-to-be-drafted Democratic bill to extend the subsidies.

Shaheen, who has been working to extend the subsidies for years, and other Senate Democrats still have more deal-making to do. They'll have to find at least 13 Senate

SENATORS, Page A6

SHUTDOWN
DAY 42

Sept. 19
Date of last House session

594,048
Workers furloughed

35 days
Longest-ever shutdown

A SOLDIER'S FINAL PLACE OF REST



Private Alfred T. Langevin has returned home. The Weymouth native was declared missing 81 years ago in some of the most brutal fighting of World War II. His remains were only recently identified. His nephew Patrick Thompson (above) and grandniece Aura Leister joined a funeral ceremony Monday at Fairmount Cemetery in Weymouth. B4. Local veterans discuss today's military. B1.



PHOTOS BY DAVID L. RYAN/GLOBE STAFF

A community pillar, now deemed a danger

Cook was long viewed as a mentor. Prosecutors have other ideas.

By Samantha J. Gross and Lea Skene
GLOBE STAFF

LaMar D. Cook was a child of Springfield. Growing up in a close-knit Black community in Western Massachusetts, he played outside under his grandmother's watchful eye. In the summer, he climbed fences and doused his brothers with water balloons.

He also experienced some of the city's biggest challenges. He lost friends to gun violence and prison. As a young man, he was arrested on gun charges. In 2017, his younger brother was killed in a nightclub shooting.

Still, Cook persevered. He graduated from college and built a career in hospitality. He co-founded a nonprofit that hosted annual back-to-school events for Springfield kids. From the

COOK, Page A10



ERIN CLARK/GLOBE STAFF

Charles Stokes, a community activist, says he's shaken by the charges against LaMar Cook, a former aide to the governor.



Gen. washing done

Tuesday: Clearing, cool, windy.
High 39-44, low 34-39.

Wednesday: Breezy, chilly.
Weather and comics, D5-6.

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The Supreme Court rejected a request that it consider overturning its landmark decision to legalize same-sex marriage. A2.

An anticorruption report said officials in Ukraine were engaged in kickbacks and money laundering in a scheme targeting the state-owned nuclear energy company. A3.

Red Sox outfielder Roman Anthony finished third in the rookie of the year balloting for the American League. C1.

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